

CASE STUDY

Rescuing and Scaling

a Learning Management Platform

Sector: Education / EdTech · Client: UK-based Learning Platform

Challenge

The Client runs a platform that helps UK employers manage apprenticeships, including the reporting needed to claim government funding and the structure needed to get apprentices through to completion. That matters because national apprenticeship completion rates sit below 50%, while our Client's platform was already achieving close to 85%. The problem was how the platform had been built: it had grown over time through a single freelance developer who eventually became uncooperative and held the company's own IP to ransom. The system was live but needed significant manual intervention every month just to keep running, and our Client had no internal technical capability of its own to fall back on.

Solution

We brought in a fractional CTO with over 15 years' experience running learning platforms in the UK, who reviewed the existing codebase and AWS setup and identified where things needed to change. Working alongside an engineering manager and two dedicated engineers, the team made short-term fixes to stabilise the platform, then moved into iterative improvements to cut down the manual work involved in keeping it running month to month. What started as an emergency fix has since grown into a long-term development partnership, with ongoing refactoring, new features and additional products now on the roadmap.

Effects

- AWS infrastructure costs halved
- Management overhead for the business owner cut by around 25%
- Monthly manual intervention significantly reduced
- Client secured additional investment on the back of the improved platform
- Relationship has grown from an emergency fix into a long-term development partnership

Stack: .NET, AWS, React



Apprenticeship Platform Health

Live · Employer & Funding Reporting

85%

Completion Rate

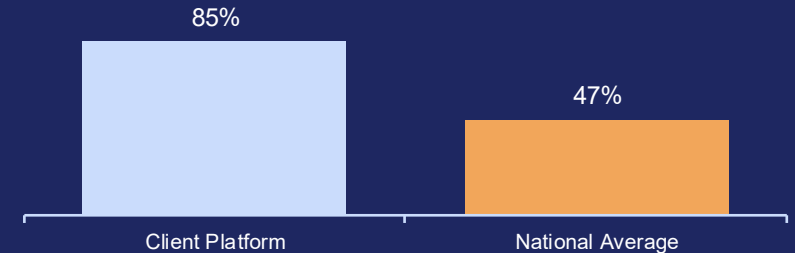
-50%

AWS Infra. Cost

-25%

Mgmt. Overhead

Completion Rate: Client vs National Avg.



AWS Infrastructure Cost



Halved after platform stabilisation
Costs down, reliability up.